

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex commercial and dispute matters at BCLP, and current legal advisory work at Citizens Advice. Experienced in legal and factual research, document review, case-file management, drafting, deadline tracking and communicating with clients on sensitive matters. Developing interest in financial markets and transactional finance law, followed up through an A&O Shearman open day, a Coursera private equity course and the Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance virtual experience programme. Strong written communication skills and comfortable working across multiple matters with competing deadlines.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, cross-border legal analysis and evidence review
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law, Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended substantive sections and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the sole junior supporting the team ahead of a significant deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external Romanian translations
- Received partner and associate feedback that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and meets deadlines
- Researches complex statutory and regulatory points; identifies evidential gaps; advises clients on procedural requirements and options
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical written guidance for clients across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Maintains confidential case records and manages a caseload of matters with competing deadlines

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis and document review; electronic bundling; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple matters